Lesson 11

# The Doctrine of Trinity

*Aim: To explain the profound Christian teaching of Trinity.*

**Introduction:**

Trinity is a fundamental Christian doctrine. It is sometimes called "mystery" because it is hard to comprehend by human mind. However no one can doubt the fact that this doctrine is sound Biblically and it has been a part of the fundamental belief of Christians for centuries.

## I. THE CONCEPT OF TRINITY.

Trinity is a belief in **one God**, existing in **three distinct persons.** "The Father is God, the Son is God, and the Holy Spirit is God. "We believe, therefore, there are three persons in the Godhead, but one God."

*Isaiah 45:5 – "I am the LORD, and there is no other; apart from me there is no God. I will strengthen you, though you have not acknowledged me…"*

*Deut. 6:4 "Hear, O Israel: The LORD our God, the LORD is one."*

## II. THE OLD TESTAMENT PROOFS OF THE TRIUNE GOD

***A. Plural name of Deity*** *– "Elohim"* is plural name in form, but singular in meaning when referring to the true God. – Gen. 1:1

*"In the beginning, God created the heavens and the earth."*

**B. In personal pronouns, use of Deity** – Gen. 1:26; Isa. 6:8

*26 Then God said, "Let us make mankind in our image, in our likeness, so that they may rule over the fish in the sea and the birds in the sky, over the livestock and all the wild animals, and over all the creatures that move along the ground."*

*8 Then I heard the voice of the Lord saying, "Whom shall I send? And who will go for us?" And I said, "Here am I. Send me!"*

## III. THE NEW TESTAMENT PROVES THE DOCTRINE OF TRINITY

**A. Father is God** – 1 Cor. 8:6

*6 yet for us there is but one God, the Father, from whom all things came and for whom we live; and there is but one Lord, Jesus Christ, through whom all things came and through whom we live.*

**B. Son is God** – Heb. 1:8

*8 But about the Son he says, "Your throne, O God, will last forever and ever;a scepter of*
*justice will be the scepter of your kingdom.*

**C. Holy Spirit is God** – Acts 5:3,4

*3 Then Peter said, "Ananias, how is it that Satan has so filled your heart that you have lied to the Holy Spirit and have kept for yourself some of the money you received for the land? 4 Didn't it belong to you before it was sold? And after it was sold, wasn't the money at your disposal? What made you think of doing such a thing? You have not lied just*

*to human beings but to God."*

**D. The Baptism of Christ** – Matt. 3:16, 17

*16 As soon as Jesus was baptized, he went up out of the water. At that moment heaven was opened, and he saw the Spirit of God descending like a dove and alighting on him. 17 And a voice from heaven said, "This is my Son, whom I love; with him I am well pleased."*

**E. The Baptismal formula** – Matt. 28:19

*19 Therefore go and make disciples of all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit,*

**F. The apostolic benediction** – 2 Cor. 13:14

*14 May the grace of the Lord Jesus Christ, and the love of God, and the fellowship of the Holy Spirit be with you all.*

**G. The Godhead -** *Colossians 2:9, Romans 1:20*

*"9 For in Christ all the fullness of the Deity lives in bodily form"*

*“20 For since the creation of the world God’s invisible qualities—his eternal power and divine nature—have been clearly seen, being understood from what has been made, so that people are without excuse.”*

*Godhead* **-** the nature of God especially as existing in three persons

## IV. ILLUSTRATION

1. **Man** – *threefold being* – 1Thess. 5:23

*23 May God himself, the God of peace, sanctify you through and through. May your whole spirit, soul and body be kept blameless at the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ.*

2. **Water** – *three forms* – liquid, vapor, solid

3. **Triangle** – *three angles in one triangle*

## IV. CONCLUSION:

The doctrine of trinity is a Biblically sound doctrine that all Christians can trust. Praise God that He is a triune being!